

Deep Dive Interview - IRS Counsel

Purpose

Understand the needs of IRS counsel when interacting with the system when creating and managing cases for clients

Participants

- [] Participant 1
- [] Participant 2
- [] Participant 3
- [] Participant 4

Interview Questions - IRS Attorney

Background Information

- What is your role? How long have you been in your current role?
- Describe the office you work in (how many attorneys, case volume, etc.)
- Case complexity?

System Use

- Do you currently use the e-filing system yourself? Do you ever have someone else use the system on your behalf?
- What do you use the current e-filing system for?
- How often do you access the system? At what times of day?
- What devices do you use to access the system? Desktop/laptop/mobile? What is your preference?
- What are you not using e-filing for?

Entering a Case

- How do you receive new petitions? What information and/or documents do you receive?
 - How are you notified that there are new petitions? How frequently?
 - Are you using ETCS? Electronic Tax Court Service to view case information? Do you use the USTC system to view case information prior to filing the Answer?
 - Do you only receive petitions that are assigned to your IRS office? Do you need to see all of the cases assigned to the entire office?
- How are cases assigned to you? How do you divide up work among attorneys in your office?
- Do you ever work cases with other IRS attorneys? What is the process to enter the case if there are multiple attorneys working on it?

- What happens when you need to remove or add attorneys from a case after the Answer has been filed?

Accessing Case Information

- Do you need to access information on cases you are not associated with?
- What information do you need to be able to view? (i.e. on the Docket Record, party information, etc.)
- How do you search for cases? What information do you use to identify a case?

Managing Cases

- How many cases do you have active at a given time?
- How do you keep track of your cases? Any offline processes?
- How do you track deadlines for your cases?
- How do you know when new information is available on a case?
 - What kinds of communication/notifications do you receive from the Court about cases? What would you have liked to receive?
- Did you have a need to access inactive/closed cases?
 - How long would you need inactive/closed case information to be available to you?

Filing Documents in a Case

- Once you've entered into a case, describe your process for submitting other filings in a case
 - How did you prepare or receive those documents?
 - How do you select the type of document you need to file?
 - Do you have certain documents that you file frequently?
 - How do you upload/scan documents to be e-filed?
 - *One document as you file? Upload beforehand in bulk?*
 - How did you keep track of those documents after they are filed?

Dashboard

- What information would you like to see on the dashboard?

Interview Questions - Administrative Staff

Background Information

- What is your role? How long have you been in your current role?
- Describe the office you work in (how many attorneys, case volume, etc.)
- How many attorneys do you support?

System Use

- Do you currently use the e-filing system? Are you using it on behalf of one or more attorneys?
- What do you use the current e-filing system for?
- How often do you access the system? At what times of day?
- What devices do you use to access the system? Desktop/laptop/mobile? What is your preference?

Accessing Case Information

- Do you need to access information for tax court cases before an IRS attorney is associated with it?
- What information do you need to be able to view? (i.e. on the Docket Record, party information, etc.)
- How do you search for cases? What information do you use to identify a case?

Entering a Case

- How does your involvement with a USTC case usually begin?
 - How do you receive new cases? What information and/or documents do you receive?
 - How are cases assigned to attorneys? How are cases divided up among the attorneys in the office?
- If you have multiple attorneys that will be working on a case, what happens?
- What happens when you need to remove an attorney from a case?

Managing Cases

- How many cases are active for the attorneys at a given time?
- How do you keep track of these cases? Any offline processes?
- How do you track deadlines for these cases?
- How do you know when new information is available on a case?

- What kinds of communication/notifications do you receive from the Court about cases? What would you have liked to receive?
- Did you have a need to access inactive/closed cases?
 - How long would you need inactive/closed case information to be available to you?

Filing Documents in a Case

- Once an attorney is entered into a case, describe your process for submitting other filings in a case
 - How did you prepare or receive those documents?
 - How do you select the type of document you need to file?
 - Do you have certain documents that you file frequently?
 - What is your process for uploading/scanning documents into the system?
 - *One document as you file? Upload beforehand in bulk?*
 - What information do you need to confirm that your filing has been successful?
 - How did you keep track of those documents after they are filed?

Dashboard

- What information would you like to see on the dashboard, as soon as you log into the system?